

Ivonne S. Lara Cortés

Education

- 2023 **M.A. in Economics**, *Universidad del Rosario*, Bogotá D.C., GPA: 4.4/5.0
Relevant Coursework: Advanced Microeconomics, Advanced Macroeconomics, Advanced Econometrics, Advanced Impact Evaluation Methods, Game Theory.
- 2023 **M.A. in Economy of Public Policies**, *Universidad del Rosario*, Bogotá D.C., GPA: 4.4/5.0
Relevant Coursework: Political Economics, Public Economics, Design and Analysis of Public Policies.
- 2021 **B.A. in Economics**, *Universidad del Rosario*, Bogotá D.C., GPA: 4.2/5.0

Additional Coursework

- 2024 **Real Analysis and Optimization (Ph.D.)**, *Universidad de los Andes*, Bogotá D.C., GPA: 4.9/5.0
Lecturer: [Dr. Andrés Carvajal](#)
- 2022 **Data Science Fellowship (DS4A)**, *Correlation One*, Bogotá D.C., Graduated with Honors

Experience

Research

- 2023 - **Pre-doctoral Research Fellow**, *DEC-DI/DIME, World Bank*, Washington D.C., (40h/week)
PI: [Dr. Arlen Guarín](#) and [Maria Ruth](#)
- **Contributed to a randomized controlled trial in Peru**, evaluating the impact of cash-based transfers for in-transit migrants on well being outcomes through survey and administrative data collection, cleaning, and analysis.
 - **Designed survey instruments, secured IRB approval, led data analysis and capacity building** for an impact evaluation in South Sudan assessing how layering livelihood activities onto cash transfers affects household socioeconomic outcomes, with a focus on gender targeting.
 - **Led a mission to Juba, South Sudan**, engaging with government stakeholders on program implementation and impact evaluation progress.
 - **Implemented sample randomization and data quality checks** for a geo-bundled social protection and agricultural intervention in Yemen.
 - **Automated data processing and visualization** of humanitarian survey and administrative databases to inform the 2024 *Syria Economic Monitor* report.
 - **Developed reproducible code and software packages** for World Bank working papers.
- 2024 - **Research Consultant**, *Collegio Carlo Alberto (CCA)*, Remote, (20h/week)
PI: [Dr. Juan Fernando Vargas](#)
- **Constructed a grid-level panel dataset** of predicted coca suitability across Colombia by applying a **Random Forest machine learning model** that integrates geospatial covariates with observed coca plantation data.
 - **Analyzed the impact of the 2014 coca crop substitution policy announcement on school outcomes** across high- vs. low-suitability areas by integrating geolocated school data from the C600, SIMAT, and Saber datasets.
- 2024 **Research Consultant**, *University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)*, Remote, (20h/week)
PI: [Dr. Juliana Londoño](#)
- Built the reproducibility package** for the Quarterly Journal of Economics paper “*The Impact of Being Denied a Wanted Abortion on Women and their Children*,” ensuring rigorous documentation, research transparency, and secure handling of sensitive judicial data (tutelas) from women in Colombia.
- 2021-23 **Graduate Research Fellow**, *Dep. of Economics, Universidad del Rosario*, Bogotá D.C., (40h/week)
PI: [Dr. Darwin Cortés](#) and [Dr. Jorge Pérez](#)
- **Evaluated the impact of Colombia’s 2006 abortion decriminalization on maternal and neonatal health** using difference-in-differences, event-study, and propensity score matching methods. Conducted **data cleaning, exploratory analysis, and micro-econometric modeling**; currently a **co-author** on the paper.
 - **Assessed the impact of the 2014 Colombian ceasefire on youth time allocation**, merging ENUT microdata from DANE with guerrilla conflict exposure data. **Obtained data access and conducted causal analysis** using difference-in-differences, propensity score matching, multiple-testing adjustments, and other quasi-experimental techniques.
 - Contributed to a paper evaluating the impact of adverse health shocks on household expenditure shares, **ensuring sample balance and parallel trends** through propensity score matching and fixed-effects estimations.

2022 **Economic Affairs Intern**, *Global Economic Monitoring - DESA, United Nations*, NYC, (40h/week)

PI: [Dr. Sebastian Vergara](#)

- **Programmed a cross-country panel dataset** to support econometric analyses and data visualizations for the 2023 *World Economic Situation and Prospects (WESP)* flagship report and monthly briefings.
- Conducted literature reviews on the effects of macroeconomic fluctuations on sustainable development, fiscal and investment multipliers, and monetary transmission channels.

Teaching Assistance

2020-21 **Microeconomics III**, *Department of Economics, Universidad del Rosario*, Bogotá D.C.

Lecturer: [Dr. Darwin Cortés](#) and [Dr. Andrea Lopez](#)

Research

Work in Progress

Hours of Peace: Youth Gender Roles, Labor Participation, and Care Time Reallocation Following the 2014 Ceasefire in Colombia. With *D. Cortés* and *D. Maldonado*. (**Former master's thesis; preparing for submission to *Demography***) [\[Link\]](#)

Monetary Policy and Innovation in Colombia. With *M. Grazzi* and *S. Vergara*. (**Accepted to present at the “9th Conference of the Latin American and Caribbean Network on the Economics of Innovation and Entrepreneurship (RIE)”**, 17–18 November 2025, Campinas-SP, Brazil) [\[Link\]](#)

Abortion Decriminalization and the Health of Live-born Children in Colombia. With *D. Cortés*, *C. Jiménez*, *P. Rodríguez*, and *P. Torres*.

When Illegal Income Keeps Children in School: Coca Expansion and Education in Colombia. With *S. Tobón*, *J.F. Vargas*, and *M. Vanegas*.

Policy Reports

Syria Economic Monitor: Conflict, Crises, and the Collapse of Household Welfare. World Bank (Spring 2024). Washington D.C. [\[Link\]](#)

World Economic Situation and Prospects 2023. United Nations (2023). New York City. [\[Link\]](#)

Informe de Caracterización y Diagnóstico de Colegios Privados de Bogotá. Secretaría de Educación (2022). Bogotá D.C. [\[Link\]](#)

Awards

Scholarship Award for Master Studies in Economics (2021-23), *Universidad del Rosario*

Merit Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies in Economics (2016-21), *Universidad del Rosario*

National and Regional Champion, Economics Debate Competition (2019), *National Federation of Economics Students (FENADECO)*

Languages

English, *Advanced (C1 - TOELF and IELTS)*

Spanish, *Native*

French, *Intermediate (A2 - DELF)*

Software Skills

R, Stata, Python, Matlab, L^AT_EX, Bloomberg, Power BI, SurveyCTO, M.S. Office

Main References

[Arlen Guarín Galeano, PhD.](#), *World Bank*
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